Massimo Lipari

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RESEARCH AREAS

Laboratory phonology, corpus phonetics, language variation and change, typology, speech dynamics, acoustic-articulatory mapping, phonetics/phonology interface

EDUCATION

2021–	*PhD, Linguistics* – McGill University (Montreal, Quebec) Advisors: Morgan Sonderegger & Meghan Clayards
2018–2021	*BA, Linguistics & Philosophy* – McGill University (Montreal, Quebec)
July–Aug 2025	*Student, LSA Summer Institute* – University of Oregon (Eugene, Oregon, USA)
Sept–Oct 2024	*Visiting student researcher* – University of Glasgow (Glasgow, Scotland) Supervised by Jane Stuart-Smith

PUBLICATIONS

Peer-reviewed journal articles

In revision	**Lipari, M.**, Sonderegger, M., & Clayards, M. Variation in the acoustic dynamics of /s/: Patterns within and across 32 languages. *PsyArXiv*. doi:10.31234/osf.io/m4ksy_v1
2025	**Lipari, M.** & Sonderegger, M. A new perspective on the development of Quebec French rhotic vowels. *Laboratory Phonology*, 16(1). doi:10.16995/labphon.11678

Book chapters

Accepted	**Lipari, M.**, Dumont, L., & Milne, P. Les « données trouvées » et la variation phonétique en français québécois. In *Les voies du français*, Presses de l'Université Laval.
2025	**Lipari, M.** Functional principal components analysis. In M. Sonderegger, M. Sóskuthy, M. Lipari & A. Doucette, *Advanced Quantitative Methods for Linguistic Data*, version 0.2. doi:10.5281/zenodo.15942068

Peer-reviewed conference proceedings

2026	**Lipari, M.**, Sonderegger, M., & Clayards, M. Disentangling sociophonetic and physiological variation in /s/ acoustics across 12 languages. In *Proceedings of Interspeech 2026* (pp. 3312–3317). ISCA. doi:10.21437/Interspeech.2026-2975
2023	**Lipari, M.** The emergence of rhotic vowels in Quebec French: A change from below? In R. Skarnitzl & J. Volín (Eds.), *Proceedings of the 20th International Congress of Phonetic Sciences* (pp. 3740–3744). International Phonetic Association.

Other conference proceedings

2023	**Lipari, M.** The acoustics of borrowed /ɚ/ in Quebec French. *Canadian Acoustics*, 51(3), 210–211.

PRESENTATIONS

Invited talks

2024 **Lipari, M.**, Sonderegger, M., & Clayards, M. Acoustic trajectories of /s/ across 17 languages [Talk]. *Glasgow University Laboratory of Phonetics*, Glasgow (Scotland).

2024 **Lipari, M.** & Sonderegger, M. Three accounts of the development of Quebec French rhotic vowels [Talk]. *Glasgow University Laboratory of Phonetics*, Glasgow (Scotland).

Conference presentations

2026 **Lipari, M.**, Sonderegger, M., & Clayards, M. A mediation analysis of gender differences in /s/ acoustics across languages [Poster]. *New Ways of Analyzing Variation 54*, Montreal (Quebec).

2026 **Lipari, M.**, Sonderegger, M., & Clayards, M. Disentangling sociophonetic and physiological variation in /s/ acoustics across 12 languages [Poster]. *Interspeech 2026*, Sydney (Australia).

2026 Li, K., Sonderegger, M., & **Lipari, M.** Cross-linguistic sibilant variability: More complex than predicted [Poster]. *20th Conference on Laboratory Phonology*, Montreal (Quebec).

2026 **Lipari, M.**, Sonderegger, M., & Clayards, M. Gender variation in /s/ across languages: Untangling physiology and performance [Poster]. *20th Conference on Laboratory Phonology*, Montreal (Quebec).

2026 **Lipari, M.**, Sonderegger, M., & Clayards, M. A cross-linguistic study of social and physiological sources of variation in /s/ acoustics [Talk]. *Montréal-Ottawa-Toronto-Hamilton-Québec Phonology/Phonetics Workshop 2026*, Quebec (Quebec).

2025 **Lipari, M.** Apparent vocal tract length versus /s/ acoustics in a large multilingual corpus [Poster]. *6th Joint Meeting of the Acoustical Society of America & the Acoustical Society of Japan*, Honolulu (USA).

2025 **Lipari, M.**, Lawson, E., & Stuart-Smith, J. Acoustic and articulatory variation across dialects in English approximant /ɹ/ [Talk]. *'R-atics 8*, Valletta (Malta).

2025 **Lipari, M.**, Lawson, E., & Stuart-Smith, J. The role of dialect and tongue shape in English /ɹ/ formant dynamics [Talk]. *Montréal-Ottawa-Toronto-Hamilton Phonology/Phonetics Workshop 2025*, Toronto (Canada).

2024 **Lipari, M.** & Sonderegger, M. The development of rhoticity in the Quebec French vowel system [Talk]. *19th Conference on Laboratory Phonology*, Seoul (Korea).

2024 **Lipari, M.**, Sonderegger, M., & Clayards, M. Cross-linguistic differences in the phonetic implementation of /s/ [Talk]. *CorpusPhon*, Seoul (Korea).

2024 **Lipari, M.** & Sonderegger, M. L'émergence des voyelles rhotiques en français québécois [Talk]. *9e colloque Les français d'ici*, Shippagan (Canada).

2024 **Lipari, M.**, Milne, P., & Sonderegger, M. Les « données trouvées » et la variation phonétique en français québécois [Talk]. *9e colloque Les français d'ici*, Shippagan (Canada).

2024 **Lipari, M.**, Sonderegger, M., & Clayards, M. Spectral properties of Quebec French sibilants [Poster]. *186th Meeting of the Acoustical Society of America*, Ottawa (Canada).

2024 **Lipari, M.**, Sonderegger, M., & Clayards, M. Spectral dynamics of Quebec French sibilants [Talk]. *Montréal-Ottawa-Toronto-Hamilton Phonology/Phonetics Workshop 2024*, Montreal (Quebec).

2023 **Lipari, M.** Variable adaptation of English /ɚ/ in Quebec French [Poster]. *New Ways of Analyzing Variation 51*, New York (USA).

2023 **Lipari, M.** The acoustics of borrowed /ɚ/ in Quebec French [Talk]. *Acoustics Week in Canada*, Montreal (Quebec).

2023 **Lipari, M.** The emergence of rhotic vowels in Quebec French: A change from below? [Poster]. *20th International Congress of Phonetic Sciences*, Prague (Czechia).

2023 **Lipari, M.** Formant trajectories of three rhotic vowels in Quebec French [Talk]. *Congress of the Canadian Linguistic Association*, Toronto (Canada).

2023 **Lipari, M.** A portrait of rhotic vowels in Quebec French [Talk]. *Montréal-Ottawa-Toronto-Hamilton Phonology/Phonetics Workshop 2023*, Hamilton (Canada).

Scientific outreach

2025 Bradford, L. & **Lipari, M.** What is linguistics? [Invited talk]. *Integrating Activity (Arts, Literature and Communication)*, Dawson College, Montreal (Quebec).

2023 Kamath, G. & **Lipari, M.** What is linguistics? [Invited talk]. *Integrating Activity (Arts, Literature and Communication)*, Dawson College, Montreal (Quebec).

2022 Kamath, G. & **Lipari, M.** What is linguistics? [Invited talk]. *Explorations Summer Camp*, Montreal (Quebec).

TEACHING & SUPERVISION

As instructor of record

Winter 2023 *Phonetics 1 (LING 330)*, McGill University

As guest lecturer

Fall 2024 *Advanced Quantitative Methods (LING 683)*, McGill University
Instructor: Morgan Sonderegger
Tutorial on functional data analysis

Summer 2024 *Meaning and Language (LING 260)*, McGill University
Instructor: Irene B. R. Smith
Lecture on adjective denotations

As teaching assistant

Winter 2026 *Phonology 1 (LING 331)*, McGill University
Instructor: Myriam Lapierre

Summer 2025 *Practical Corpus Phonetics*, LSA Summer Institute
Instructors: Morgan Sonderegger & Michael McAuliffe

Summer 2025 *Bayesian Regression Modelling for Language Data*, LSA Summer Institute
Instructor: Morgan Sonderegger

Winter 2024 *Meaning and Language (LING 260)*, McGill University
Instructor: Mathieu Paillé

Fall 2023 *Intro to Linguistics (LING 201)*, McGill University
Instructor: Andrei Munteanu

Fall 2022 *Semantics 1 (LING 360)*, McGill University
Instructor: Brendan Gillon

As supervisor

May 2026– *RA supervisor*, Montréal Computational & Quantitative Linguistics Lab, McGill University
Supervised undergraduate students Hazel Grover, Ian Gifford, & Julia Lusby in developing software for easier hand-correction of formant tracks and in producing a gold-standard cross-linguistic dataset of validated formant measures.

Winter 2026 *Partner*, Students-As-Partners French Terminology Project, McGill University
Supervised undergraduate students Gabriel Gefin & Samantha Stong in developing French-English glossaries for computational linguistics & speech-language pathology.

Jan–Aug 2024 *Mentor*, Program for Undergraduate Research in Linguistics, McGill University
Mentored undergraduate student Laurie Dumont in using found data for speech corpus creation/management.

Summer 2023 *RA supervisor*, Montréal Computational & Quantitative Linguistics Lab, McGill University
Supervised undergraduate student Talia Gottfred in using found data for speech corpus creation/management.

As grader

Fall 2023 *Experimental Methods (LING 620)*, McGill University
Instructor: Morgan Sonderegger

OTHER ACADEMIC EXPERIENCE

As research assistant

Summer 2026 *For Morgan Sonderegger*, McGill University
Created various tools (e.g., G2P rulesets, pronunciation dictionaries, trained acoustic models) for forced alignment of large speech corpora across multiple languages.

Summer 2025 *For Morgan Sonderegger*, McGill University
Ran a users' group and developed documentation for a Python speech corpus management API, *PolyglotDB*.

Jan–Aug 2021 *For Michael Wagner*, McGill University
Helped develop stimuli for prosody experiments run online through *Prolific*.

FUNDING AND AWARDS

Fellowships & bursaries

2024–2027 *Doctoral Award*, Social Sciences and Humanities Research Council of Canada (CAD 120,000)

2024–2028 *B2Z (Doctoral) Award*, Fonds de recherche du Québec (CAD 91,667, reduced to CAD 1,667)
Terminated early due to overlap with SSHRC award

2022–2023 *B1Z (Master's) Award*, Fonds de recherche du Québec (CAD 17,500)

2021–2022 *Canada Graduate Scholarship – Master's*, Social Sciences and Humanities Research Council of Canada (CAD 17,500)

2018–2019 *J. W. McConnell Entrance Scholarship*, McGill University (CAD 3,000)

Other awards & honours

2026	*Graduate Student Travel Award*, Centre for Research on Brain, Language and Music (CAD 700)
2025	*LSA Summer Institute Fellowship*, Linguistic Society of America (USD 2,500)
2025	*Graduate Mobility Award*, McGill University (CAD 1,575)
2025	*Graduate Student Travel Award*, Centre for Research on Brain, Language and Music (CAD 700)
2025	*Graduate Research Enhancement and Travel Award*, Department of Linguistics, McGill University (CAD 500)
2024	*McGill–Glasgow Travel Award*, McGill University (CAD 2,625)
2024	*Travel Award*, McGill Post-Graduate Students' Society (CAD 700)
2023	*Student Travel Award*, International Phonetic Association (GBP 600)
2023	*Graduate Student Travel Award*, Centre for Research on Brain, Language and Music (CAD 350)
2023	*Student Travel Award*, Department of Linguistics, McGill University (CAD 350)

ACADEMIC SERVICE

Academic journal peer-review

2026	*Journal of Phonetics* (1)
2024	*JASA Express Letters* (1)

Conference abstract peer-review

2024	*55th Annual Conference on African Linguistics* (10)

Conference organization

2025–2026	*Organizing committee member*, 20th Conference on Laboratory Phonology
2024	*Organizing committee member*, Montréal-Ottawa-Toronto-Hamilton Phonology/Phonetics Workshop 2024

Departmental service

2025–2026	*President*, Graduate Linguistics Association of McGill, McGill University
2025–2026	*Meeting coordinator*, Speech Learning Lab + Montréal Computational & Quantitative Linguistics Lab, McGill University
2024–2025	*Graduate student representative*, Department of Linguistics, McGill University
2025	*Graduate student representative*, Assistant Professor in Phonology search committee, McGill University
2022–2024	*Co-organizer*, Phonetics/Phonology reading group, McGill University
2024	*Co-organizer*, Bayesian statistics reading group, McGill University

TECHNICAL SKILLS

Statistics	Generalized additive modelling, frequentist & Bayesian regression, functional data analysis, causal inference, dimensionality reduction
Programming	*R*: data wrangling & analysis, statistical analysis, geospatial data analysis *Python*: data wrangling, analysis & visualization, machine learning *bash*: scripting, remote computing *git*: version control
Authoring	*Quarto/R Markdown*, *LaTeX*
Other	*Praat*: acoustic analysis/signal processing, scripting, phonetic annotation

LANGUAGES

English (native), *French* (near-native), *German* (advanced), *Italian* (heritage), *Japanese* (beginner)

Updated October 2026